

Sakshi Agarwal uses her Ferrari 296 GT for something unexpectedly domestic: taking her children out for an evening spin

The buying process is different too. A ₹2.5-crore or a ₹3-crore automobile is approached with the seriousness of a property acquisition, Ahuja says. Women customers often want to understand pricing, insurance, taxation, servicing, and resale implications in considerable depth before committing.

That is not lack of interest in cars, she argues, but a consequence of traditionally being excluded from many of the financial and automotive conversations that men grew up hearing. "Women need more handholding," she says.

Ahuja recalls that when Queens Drive Club began five years ago, some husbands would telephone her, worried that their wives had taken the household supercar out on a club drive. In the past two or three years, she has seen almost the reverse: husbands actively encouraging their wives to buy or drive one so they can participate.

Queens Drive Club now has more than 100 members around India. In Delhi, smaller groups frequently drive together on routes such as Dwarka Expressway and Noida-Agra Expressway, while cars are transported from different cities on flatbeds for the club's annual drive. What began during Covid simply as a group of women wanting the mood-changing rush of getting behind the wheel has evolved into a national community.

For Singh, that freedom is what being behind the wheel is all about. On weekends, she and her husband leave Lonavala in separate cars. He drives his. She drives hers.

"I don't want to be the passenger princess anymore," she says. BT